

SPARTAN COACHING

DISCIPLINE | EMPATHY | STRATEGY

NEW HIRE ONBOARDING PLAN

A Complete 90-Day Ramp for Hospice Sales Representatives

Daily action items, knowledge milestones, coaching checkpoints, activity targets, and success indicators for the first 90 days in a hospice sales role.

New Hire Onboarding Plan

Your First 90 Days: A Roadmap to Consistent Performance

THE PHILOSOPHY BEHIND THIS PLAN

The biggest mistake new hospice sales reps make is trying to sell before they are ready to serve. In the first 30 days, your job is to learn, not to pitch. The accounts that you introduce yourself to during this period will form impressions that last for years. Make those impressions count by showing up as genuinely curious, clinically interested, and focused on their world — not yours.

The Spartan Method new hire ramp is built on a simple progression: knowledge, then presence, then credibility, then referrals. Reps who shortcut this progression by pushing for referrals before they have established credibility typically plateau early. Reps who trust the progression typically outperform their targets by month 4 and sustain that performance for years.

WEEK 1: ORIENTATION AND FOUNDATION

Administrative and Clinical Onboarding

- ☐ Complete all HR paperwork and company orientation requirements
- ☐ Review compliance training including HIPAA, Anti-Kickback Statute, and your organization's policies
- ☐ Receive CRM access and complete 2-hour system training with your manager
- ☐ Receive territory assignment, account list, and any existing relationship notes from your predecessor
- ☐ Review the Medicare Hospice Benefit summary and take the self-assessment quiz

Clinical Team Integration

- ☐ Meet each member of your assigned clinical team: nurses, social workers, aide coordinators, chaplain, and medical director
- ☐ Shadow a nurse on at least two patient visits (with appropriate patient consent obtained by the clinical team)
- ☐ Attend one family meeting or care planning conference
- ☐ Attend one clinical team meeting to understand how patient care decisions are made
- ☐ Review your organization's service offerings: routine home care, continuous care, respite, and inpatient

Field Learning

- ☐ Complete 2 full days of field shadowing with an experienced rep or your manager
- ☐ Observe how the experienced rep conducts a first visit, a follow-up visit, and a lunch-and-learn
- ☐ Debrief every field visit the same day: what worked, what did not, what questions came up
- ☐ Begin building your personal territory account list with all contacts identified

WEEK 2: TERRITORY MAPPING

Account Research

- ☐ Map all referral sources in your territory by type: SNF, hospital, physician, ALF, home health, other
- ☐ Research your top 20 highest-potential accounts using CMS data, LinkedIn, and news sources
- ☐ Identify key decision-makers at each account: name, role, tenure, and any known preferences
- ☐ Complete a competitive analysis: which hospice providers are active in your territory and where?
- ☐ Apply the initial A/B/C tiering to your account list based on your research

Personal Skills Development

- ☐ Practice your 30-second opener until it is completely natural — record yourself and review the recording
- ☐ Study the 5 Stage 1 Discovery questions and be able to deliver each one conversationally, not from memory
- ☐ Review all six disease-specific eligibility criteria in the Quick Reference guide
- ☐ Complete a second field ride-along, this time focusing specifically on how discovery questions are used

WEEKS 3 AND 4: INITIAL OUTREACH (INTRODUCTION MODE)

Daily Activity Targets at 50% Ramp

- Minimum 5 live referral source conversations per day
- Visit at least 4 new accounts for first introductions per day
- Send at least 3 follow-up emails per day, same-day for any meaningful conversations
- Document every visit in CRM within 4 hours

Week 3 and 4 Checklist

- ☐ Introduce yourself at every A Tier account in your territory (in-person preferred)
- ☐ Deliver a value message in every introduction: what you do for their patients, not your company features
- ☐ Ask at least one Stage 1 Discovery question in every first visit
- ☐ Schedule your first lunch-and-learn for week 5 or 6
- ☐ Complete a weekly call review with your manager: discuss 3 best conversations and 3 where you felt stuck
- ☐ Receive your first coaching feedback on your opener and discovery question delivery

MONTH 2: RELATIONSHIP BUILDING AND FIRST REFERRALS

Daily Activity Targets at 70% Ramp

- Minimum 7 live referral source conversations per day
- At least 2 educational leave-behinds delivered per day
- 100% of visits documented in CRM same day
- Minimum 1 Stage 2 Connecting conversation per day with an existing contact

Month 2 Checklist

- ☐ Begin second-round visits at all A Tier accounts with a specific educational agenda per visit
- ☐ Conduct at least 2 lunch-and-learn presentations during the month
- ☐ Study objection handling and practice the ACE method with your manager
- ☐ Identify 3 accounts where a first referral may be possible and develop a specific plan for each
- ☐ Track your weekly conversion metrics and share with your manager in coaching meetings
- ☐ Receive your first referral (target: by the end of week 6)

MONTH 3: FULL PACE OPERATIONS

Daily Activity Targets at Full Pace

- Minimum 9 live referral source conversations per day
- Operating on full A/B/C visit cadence (A weekly, B every 2 weeks, C monthly)
- All CRM documentation complete within 24 hours
- Minimum 4 lunch-and-learns per month

Month 3 Checklist

- ☐ Receiving regular referrals from at least 3 active referral sources
- ☐ Monthly admission total is at or near the assigned goal for your territory
- ☐ Completed your first formal territory review with your manager
- ☐ Built champion relationships at a minimum of 3 A Tier accounts
- ☐ Identified your weakest skill area and have a specific improvement plan in place
- ☐ Prepared your 90-day report covering account progression, activity metrics, and next-quarter goals

COACHING CHECKPOINTS

Schedule the following coaching sessions with your manager before your first day:

Timing	Format	Focus
End of Week 2	Territory review meeting	Account tier list review and territory plan
End of Week 4	Field ride-along	Live observation of your first account visits
End of Month 1	Coaching session	CRM review, opener and discovery question feedback
End of Month 2	Coaching session	Objection handling review, first referral debrief
End of Month 3	Formal territory review	Full 90-day performance and next-quarter goal setting

THE MOST IMPORTANT 90 DAYS

The habits you build in your first 90 days will shape your career in hospice sales. Reps who build strong documentation habits, genuine curiosity habits, and daily activity discipline in the first 90 days almost always go on to be top performers. Reps who develop shortcut habits in the first 90 days carry those habits forward and rarely break out of mediocrity. Do it right from day one.